Acknowledgements

This book is about Bhagat Singh, the unacclaimed hero of the Indian freedom struggle. It is a sequel to my recent book *The Execution of Bhagat Singh: Heresies of the Raj*, but unlike that book, which focussed to a substantial degree on the trial proceedings leading up to the execution of Bhagat Singh, this one sets out to examine the wider aspects of his life in revolution. The original materials in this book that I consulted during my research are from the Lahore Archives at the offices of the Punjab Civil Secretariat in the tree-lined precincts of Anarkali, where, just as the gardeners outside tend to the flowers, the officials tend to the priceless documentation inside with meticulous care and attention. What follows is the fruit of my labours, a result of the unstinting assistance that I have received there. Needless to say, I alone remain responsible for what unfolds in the pages here and all errors are mine alone. Although this is my second book on this subject, the more I have researched and written the more I have realized that even after almost a hundred years after the death of Bhagat Singh, I am only scratching the surface. As Christopher Hill once explained, history has to be rewritten in every generation, because although the past does not change, the present does. So, the writing of history is a continual process, and I would hope, therefore, that the reader will follow through with some of the sources cited and participate in casting further light on the life and death of a person whom *India Today* has described as 'the greatest Indian'.

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